# BALACHANDAR RAMALINGAM

**Director, Software Engineering | Data Platforms & GenAI | Global Engineering Leadership**

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Enterprise technology and engineering leader with two decades of experience driving large-scale **digital transformation**, **enterprise application modernization**, **data engineering**, and **AI-led** change across global organizations in **Healthcare, Banking, and Insurance**. Own end-to-end **technology roadmaps** and build **secure, scalable digital ecosystems**, leading a **multi-tier engineering organization of 50+** across three **GCC locations** — **5 squads** with **2 engineering managers and 5 tech leads** reporting — while influencing **VP- and CxO-level** stakeholders and owning a **technology portfolio budget of up to $20M**, including resource, SOW, CapEx, and OpEx management with **P&L accountability**.

Deep expertise in **enterprise architecture**, **cloud modernization**, **data pipelines**, **AI engineering**, and **enterprise integration (ERP / SAP)**. Lead engineering of **ETL and ELT** workloads using **Databricks**, **Apache Spark**, the **PySpark engine**, **Python notebooks**, and **SQL**, connecting governed enterprise data with scalable analytics and **Generative AI (GenAI)** platforms. Championed the enterprise-wide rollout of **GIGI**, an employee-centric **Conversational AI platform** adopted by **88K+ employees** across **7 countries and 9 business units**, processing **20M+ AI interactions** with **71% positive user feedback**. Pair executive scope with a hands-on, **high-agency** approach to architecture, technical **POCs / POVs**, engineering governance, and production delivery in regulated environments under **GxP, SOX, PCI DSS, and GDPR**.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Senior Principal
**GSK**
*Bengaluru, India*

*Aug 2021 – Present*

- Lead the **global strategy and roadmap** for a portfolio of **enterprise applications** (GIGI, Site2Test, Sales Performance, Supplier Portal), delivering a unified, secure, and scalable **digital ecosystem** that improves workforce **productivity and collaboration** for a large global workforce.
- Established the enterprise **agentic AI strategy and delivery model**, introducing **NINA**, a reusable multi-agent platform built with **LangGraph / LangChain**, and deploying autonomous agents and copilots for **BRD generation, requirements analysis, functional regression, and non-functional load testing** to improve delivery speed and quality across the end-to-end **SDLC**.
- Owned the end-to-end **employee technology experience lifecycle** for **GIGI**, an enterprise **digital workplace platform** spanning Web, Android, and iOS. Scaled adoption to **88K+ active employees** and **87,873 users** who asked **20.3M questions** — driving **20M+ AI interactions** (**11.6M** writing, **5M** Q&A, **1M** document analysis) across **7 countries** and **9 business units**, with **71% positive user feedback** (54,970 of 80,275 responses).
- Directed engineering of scalable **batch and data pipelines** on **Databricks** and **Apache Spark**, using **Python notebooks**, **SQL**, and the **PySpark engine** for governed **ETL / ELT**, data transformation, and downstream analytics and **GenAI** use cases.
- Maintained hands-on engineering contribution through **coding, architecture, technical prototyping, code review, and production debugging** across **Python, .NET, Node.js, and ReactJS**, delivering reusable AI capabilities on an **API-first microservices** stack with custom agents, **MCP Server**, **LLM Gateway**, and **Kong Gateway** across Azure and AWS; adopted **GitHub Copilot** for peer PR review.
- Scaled responsible enterprise adoption and enablement — **74K employees completed all three structured GIGI certification trainings** — embedding safe, governed **AI usage** across the global workforce.
- Accountable for the **enterprise platform modernization portfolio**, investment priorities, and engineering standards across **Azure and AWS** — establishing reusable AI capabilities, API-first integration patterns, and governance that accelerated product delivery and enterprise adoption.

- Set technical direction for the enterprise **RAG and vector-search platform** and implemented **LLM-as-a-judge evaluation** for NINA-generated requirements, scoring accuracy, completeness, and hallucination against reference rubrics; integrated evaluation scores and distributed traces into **Langfuse** quality gates to improve **model explainability, traceability, auditability**, and drift detection.
- Led discovery and requirements refinement with Product and engineering stakeholders, translating ambiguous business needs into **system designs, testable acceptance criteria, delivery estimates, and release plans** for complex enterprise products.
- Integrated custom enterprise applications with **ERP (SAP)** systems, leading the tech team for the SAP approval interface — automating **426K+ approvals across 7 enterprise systems** (SailPoint, SAP GRC, ServiceNow, SharePoint, GRP) to streamline governed enterprise workflows.
- Own a **technology portfolio budget of up to $20M** with **P&L accountability**, governing workforce and resource allocation, partner **Statements of Work (SOW)**, **CapEx**, and **OpEx** across GCC locations while aligning investment with transformation priorities and driving **cost optimization**.
- Manage **strategic vendors and delivery partners** and govern **senior-stakeholder relationships** across business units — aligning contracts, SLAs, and capacity with roadmap priorities to deliver enterprise outcomes.
- Delivered the organization's first **Kubernetes / AKS service**, enabling standardized container-based delivery through **Azure Container Registry** and **Kong Gateway**, and reducing **Azure** expenditure by **~$1.2M** through workload and gateway modernization.
- Govern enterprise-wide **functional transformation programs** through engineering standards, **release governance**, **automated quality gates**, and best practices that sustain complex, highly available **cloud-native** systems at enterprise scale.
- Designed the **operating model** for project deliverables and **BAU / production support**, tailored to each application's category and business impact — defining **service delivery** tiers, ownership, and escalation paths to sustain enterprise applications post-deployment.
- Standardized **IT service management** using **ServiceNow (SNOW)** for **Incident, Change, and Problem Management** — leading major-incident triage, **root-cause analysis (RCA)**, structured **postmortems**, corrective-action tracking, and lessons-learned reviews that reduced the top 10% of unplanned outages and improved **Incident SLA** attainment from **60% to 80%**.
- Lead a **multi-tier engineering organization of 50+** across **three GCC locations** — **5 squads** with **2 engineering managers and 5 tech leads** reporting.

### Engineering Manager
**TESCO**

*Bengaluru, India*

*Oct 2009 – Aug 2021*

- Set up and led **development teams across 2 GCC locations** for multiple enterprise programs, owning **product roadmap** delivery for **Tesco Digital Wallet Pay+** in partnership with Engineering and Product leadership.
- Shaped engineering careers — partnering with the centralized technology team to formalize the enterprise **career framework** for the Bank, embedding capability frameworks and workforce development that grew talent across the organization.
- Developed engineers through **coaching**, performance assessments, feedback, and structured development plans, consistently growing talent into senior roles.
- Owned **hiring, performance calibration, promotions, succession planning, and retention** — **reduced attrition from 13% to 5%** through structured career progression and mentoring, **promoted 5 engineers from mid-level to senior grade**, and cross-trained talent across roles to build a resilient leadership bench.
- Designed and implemented enterprise **automations** across software development and service management, improving team **productivity** and process maturity.
- Established real-time service dashboards using **SSRS, APM, ServiceNow, and Azure Metrics** to improve operational visibility and reliability.
- Communicated highly technical concepts effectively to varied audiences, supporting structured technical decision-making and **collaboration** across **cross-functional teams**.

**Senior Software Engineer**
**LanceSoft India Pvt Ltd**
*Bangalore, India*
*Dec 2007 – Sep 2009*

- Delivered enterprise application development for **Linqpay**, a **credit card payment gateway**, across full software development lifecycles, from design through deployment and support.

**Software Engineer**
**Accenture Services Pvt Ltd**
*Bangalore, India*
*Jul 2005 – Nov 2007*

- Built and supported the software solution for UK insurance provider **RSA** through **agile squads**.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

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| **Engineering Leadership & Organization** | Global Engineering Leadership (50+) • Manager-of-Managers Leadership • Organization Design • Hiring & Workforce Planning • Performance Calibration • Talent Development • Succession Planning • Executive Influence |
| **Data Engineering & Analytics Platforms** | Databricks • Apache Spark • PySpark • Python Notebooks • Python • SQL • Data Pipelines • Batch Processing • ETL • ELT • Data Transformation • Data Governance |
| **Enterprise AI & Platform Strategy** | Model Explainability • Generative AI (GenAI) • Agentic AI • Conversational AI • Multi-Agent Platforms • LangGraph / LangChain • RAG & Enterprise Search • Reusable AI Capabilities • Product & Technology Roadmaps • Responsible AI |
| **Architecture, Reliability & Security** | Enterprise Architecture • Cloud-Native Platforms • Distributed Systems • API-First Microservices • Enterprise Web Services • Kubernetes / AKS • Azure Container Registry • Reliability Engineering • SDLC Governance • Security & Compliance (GxP, SOX, PCI DSS, GDPR) |
| **DevOps, Quality & Tooling** | Hands-On Coding • Code Review • Production Debugging • DevOps & CI/CD • Release Governance • Acceptance Criteria & Estimation • Automated Quality Gates • Functional Regression • Load Testing • Selenium • JMeter • BrowserStack • Postman • SonarQube • Black Duck • Invicti • ZAP • Azure DevOps • GitHub Actions • Terraform |
| **Financial, Vendor & Delivery Governance** | Portfolio Budget Ownership (up to $20M) • P&L Accountability • CapEx & OpEx Management • Resource & SOW Cost Governance • Financial Planning • Cost Optimization • Vendor & Stakeholder Management • Operating Models • Cross-Functional Delivery |

## CERTIFICATIONS

- LUMA Certified Practitioner in Design Thinking
- Automation Anywhere Certified RPA Professional
- IBM Certified Professional — WebSphere Enterprise Service Bus V7.0 Integration Development
- Microsoft Certified Professional Developer — Enterprise Application (MCPD EA)
- Microsoft AI Boot Camp

## EDUCATION

**Bachelor of Technology, Computer Science** — Vellore Institute of Technology, 2005